

CURRICULUM | 2026

STANDARDS ALIGNMENT MAP

Every deliverable, mapped to a standard.

Ohio Learning Standards 2018 | CCSS ELA and Mathematics | Grades 5 to 8



HOW TO USE THIS MAP

Administrators and curriculum directors ask one question about any new unit: which standards does it cover? This document answers that question deliverable by deliverable. Use it in your administrator proposal, in curriculum review, and when a colleague asks why science fair work belongs in an ELA or Math classroom.

Ohio Learning Standards for Science, 2018 revision, treats scientific inquiry as a set of abilities rather than content topics. The inquiry band for grades 5 to 8 is the backbone of this unit, and the science fair process addresses every ability in it. Content standards vary with the topic each student selects, which is why they are noted by area rather than by code.

OHIO LEARNING STANDARDS FOR SCIENCE, GRADES 5 TO 8 INQUIRY BAND

INQUIRY ABILITY	WHERE STUDENTS DEMONSTRATE IT
Identify questions that can be answered through scientific investigations	Topic Brainstorming Worksheet; testable question milestone
Design and conduct a scientific investigation with appropriate controls	Experimental Design Planner; design approval checkpoint
Use mathematics and measurement tools to gather and record data	Lab notebook entries; Data Collection Sheets
Analyze and interpret data to develop explanations	Data analysis week; graph construction; CER conclusion
Communicate scientific procedures and explanations	Research paper; display board; oral presentation

DELIVERABLE TO STANDARD CROSSWALK

Each row lists a student deliverable and the standards it satisfies across subjects. Codes follow Ohio Learning Standards for Science 2018 and the Common Core State Standards for ELA and Mathematics.

DELIVERABLE	SCIENCE	ELA AND LITERACY	MATHEMATICS
Testable research question	OLS inquiry: identify testable questions	RST.6–8.1	6.SP.A.1
Background research summary	OLS inquiry: use evidence	RST.6–8.1, RST.6–8.2, RST.6–8.8, WHST.6–8.7, WHST.6–8.8	Not applicable
Hypothesis, if–then–because	OLS inquiry: develop explanations	WHST.6–8.1	Not applicable
Experimental design and procedure	OLS inquiry: design with controls	RST.6–8.3, WHST.6–8.2	7.SP.A.1 to 2
Lab notebook and journal entries	OLS inquiry: gather and record data	WHST.6–8.4	6.SP.B.4
Data table with trials and averages	OLS inquiry: use measurement tools	Not applicable	6.SP.B.4, 6.SP.B.5
Graph of results	OLS inquiry: analyze and interpret data	SL.6–8.5	6.SP.B.4, 8.SP.A.1, 8.SP.A.3
CER conclusion	OLS inquiry: develop explanations from data	WHST.6–8.1	7.SP.B.3
Research paper	OLS inquiry: communicate procedures	WHST.6–8.2, WHST.6–8.5, WHST.6–8.7, WHST.6–8.8	Not applicable
Display board	OLS inquiry: communicate explanations	SL.6–8.5	6.SP.B.4
Oral presentation to judges	OLS inquiry: communicate explanations	SL.6–8.4, SL.8.4, SL.8.5	Explaining data verbally with precision

STANDARD CODE REFERENCE

Full text of each code cited in this map, for administrators reviewing the unit against district requirements.

CCSS ELA AND LITERACY IN SCIENCE AND TECHNICAL SUBJECTS

- RST.6–8.1** Cite specific textual evidence to support analysis of science and technical texts.
- RST.6–8.2** Determine the central ideas or conclusions of a text; provide an accurate summary.
- RST.6–8.3** Follow precisely a multistep procedure when carrying out experiments.
- RST.6–8.8** Distinguish among facts, reasoned judgment, and speculation in a text.
- RST.6–8.10** Read and comprehend science and technical texts independently and proficiently.

CCSS WRITING IN HISTORY, SCIENCE, AND TECHNICAL SUBJECTS

- WHST.6–8.1** Write arguments focused on discipline-specific content.
- WHST.6–8.2** Write informative and explanatory texts, including scientific procedures and experiments.
- WHST.6–8.4** Produce clear and coherent writing appropriate to task, purpose, and audience.
- WHST.6–8.5** Develop and strengthen writing by planning, revising, editing, and rewriting.
- WHST.6–8.7** Conduct short research projects to answer a question, drawing on several sources.
- WHST.6–8.8** Gather relevant information from multiple sources, assess credibility, and cite accurately.

CCSS SPEAKING AND LISTENING

- SL.6–8.4** Present claims and findings in a focused, coherent manner with relevant evidence.
- SL.6–8.5** Include multimedia components and visual displays to clarify information.
- SL.8.4** Present claims and findings with sound reasoning, well-chosen details, and appropriate eye contact and volume.
- SL.8.5** Integrate multimedia and visual displays into presentations to clarify information.

CCSS MATHEMATICS, STATISTICS AND PROBABILITY

- 6.SP.A.1** Recognize a statistical question as one that anticipates variability in the data.
- 6.SP.B.4** Display numerical data in plots on a number line, including dot plots, histograms, and box plots.
- 6.SP.B.5** Summarize numerical data sets in relation to their context.
- 7.SP.A.1** Understand that statistics can be used to gain information about a population from a sample.
- 7.SP.A.2** Use data from a random sample to draw inferences about a population.
- 7.SP.B.3** Informally assess the degree of visual overlap of two numerical data distributions.
- 8.SP.A.1** Construct and interpret scatter plots for bivariate measurement data.
- 8.SP.A.3** Use the equation of a linear model to solve problems in the context of bivariate data.

VERIFY BEFORE SUBMISSION

Standard codes and wording were current as of the 2026 edition of this curriculum. Confirm against your district’s adopted standards documents before including this map in a formal curriculum review.